

Jia Liu

Product Designer

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SUMMARY

Product designer with 8 years turning ambiguous, technical problems into things teams can build and customers can trust. That instinct shows up in flowcharts, data-flow diagrams, and decision frameworks, most recently leading a 4-designer team through an 8-month platform launch with a 90% reduction in processing time.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Benchling

Jun 2021 - Aug 2025, San Francisco, CA

Lead Product Designer

Aug 2024 - Aug 2025, Philadelphia, PA

- Led a team of 4 designers across 5 engineering teams to design and launch Bioanalytical, a new end-to-end platform for biopharma customers, onboarding 400+ users by August 2025.
- Replaced six legacy systems with one unified workflow: reduced data throughput time by 90%, cut manual tasks by 25%, and supported 1.1M samples in production, a 10x efficiency gain independently reported by Axendia.
- Drove 3 additional customer expansion opportunities through organic word-of-mouth adoption inside Merck, with one deal on track to close within months, validating the approach beyond the original account.
- Led customer discovery with Bioanalytical's charter customer (Merck), co-designing the solution through on-site research and design sprints, then translated an ambitious early concept into concrete designs across studies, procedures, plate-based workflows, instruments, and analysis.
- Coached the team on structured decision-making, introducing an explicit RACI-style framework (owner, approver, consulted) for design decisions, and modeling how to map tradeoffs against priorities and constraints for ambiguous calls.

Senior Product Designer

Feb 2023 - Aug 2024, Philadelphia, PA

- Onboarded and mentored a new designer, including scoping a freeze/thaw and expiration-dates project and modeling design practices like structuring product discussions and PM collaboration.
- Helped ship a group-by feature in search that let users visualize two levels of hierarchy at once.

Product Designer

Jun 2021 - Feb 2023

- Led design for Sample Control Roles, partnering with a PM and an engineering lead over a nine-month build. Solved a compliance and access-control gap in sample ownership that was stalling enterprise deals with regulated lab customers, giving admins clear controls over sample access and restriction.
- Sole designer leading design across three simultaneous platform areas, Inventory, Registry, and Schemas, across both customer-facing and internal use cases.
- Unblocked enterprise deals stalled on sample approval workflows by recommending Benchling adapt its existing workflow system rather than build a new automation engine, based on customer interviews and competitive research.

Product Designer | LinkedIn

Sep 2018 - May 2021, San Francisco, CA

- Owned Recruiter messaging features end to end.
- Shipped a quick reply feature to the consumer app, contributing to a 5% increase in message accept rates.
- Created interactive user personas and journey maps, adopted by a 200+ person product team.

EDUCATION

Master's in HCI | Carnegie Mellon University

BA Molecular Biology | UC Berkeley

SKILLS

Design: Interaction design, Visual design, User research, Usability testing, Design systems, Prototyping, Information architecture, Accessibility (WCAG 2.1)

Practice: Customer research, UX research, Data-informed decision making, Cross-functional leadership, Complex/technical domain translation, Compliance & regulated-industry design, Executive & stakeholder communication, Mentorship, AI-assisted prototyping

Design Tools: Figma Make, Cursor, Claude Design, Claude Code, Figma, FigJam, Adobe Photoshop, Adobe Illustrator, Framer